

Social Media Video Cheat Sheet 2026

Platform-native formats, lengths & specs — from the team producing for UBS, Siemens, Porsche and ON.

Native specs aren't compliance — they're competitive advantage. We've measured ~40% higher engagement with platform-native formats vs. stretched re-uploads.

PLATFORM	FORMAT	FRAME RATE	IDEAL LENGTH	NOTES
YouTube Shorts	1080×1920 (9:16)	30–60 fps	≤ 60 s	H.264/VP9 · file ≤ 256 MB · vertical is the native expectation
YouTube long-form	1920×1080 (16:9)	60 fps	8–12 min	H.264 · ≤ 68 Mbps · watch-time beats duration — don't pad
Instagram Reels	1080×1920 (9:16)	30–60 fps	≤ 90 s	H.264 · aggressive compression: avoid extreme colour grades
Instagram Stories	1080×1920 (9:16)	30 fps	≤ 15 s	Same vertical asset as Reels works
Instagram Feed	1080×1350 (4:5)	30 fps	—	Increasingly buried — prioritize Reels
TikTok	1080×1920 (9:16)	30 fps	15–34 s	H.264 · 5–8 Mbps · NO watermarks · native audio weighs heavily
LinkedIn	1080×1080 (1:1) / 1080×1350 (4:5)	30 fps	60–90 s	Native upload only · muted autoplay → burn-in captions

Three rules that outperform any spec

1. Shoot once, deliver native: plan the shoot so every platform gets its own crop — not a stretched copy.
2. The first second is the thumbnail: muted autoplay everywhere means your hook must work without sound.
3. Captions always: burned-in subtitles lift completion on every platform, in every language.